

GOOSEBERRIES *Ribes uva-crispa*

If, like most people, you've only tasted store-bought fruits, homegrown gooseberries are often much sweeter than you might imagine. Dessert varieties are delicious eaten fresh from the bush; culinary types make excellent jams and desserts; or grow dual-purpose berries and enjoy the best of both worlds. Easy to grow, and happily trained into cordons or fans, gooseberries are an asset to any garden.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Plant bare-root gooseberries in fall or early spring, and container-grown plants at any time of year. Ensure that container-grown plants have not become pot-bound, and select bushes that have a clear 6 in (15 cm) of stem between the roots and young branches. Gooseberries need a well-drained soil, so dig in some well-rotted manure or compost to improve the structure, if necessary; they prefer a slightly acid pH. Bushes will need frost protection, since they produce blossoms early in the year, so site them carefully, avoiding frost pockets, or grow them in pots so they can be moved under cover in colder months. Gooseberries are



Prune new side-shoots in summer.

self-fertile, so you will only need one plant to produce a crop; if you grow more than one, bushes will need 5 ft (1.5 m) of space between them; space single-stemmed cordons 14 in (35 cm) apart.

CROP CARE

Stake young plants, and protect against frost. Ensure that bushes have plenty of water, apply a balanced fertilizer, and mulch